

US Credit Unions & Community Banks

The deployment factory — productising CRM transformation for twelve institutions

Twelve community financial institutions, one delivery team, six years. Each one wanted a tailored implementation and each one had roughly the same underlying problem — which is only exploitable if someone builds the factory before the third client arrives.

12	6	2.8×	~3×	1	3
institutions delivered	years, one owning team	portfolio revenue growth, FY22–FY26	live recurring revenue growth	reusable platform	things that stayed bespoke

PORTFOLIO CONTEXT · US CREDIT UNIONS AND COMMUNITY BANKS

Institutions from roughly \$500m to \$3.6bn in assets · common core-banking estate · member 360, servicing, lending, marketing and analytics

Aditya Singh · Senior Manager — productisation and portfolio delivery · 2020–2026

Vendor, platform and product names removed. Portfolio growth is expressed as reported ratios rather than absolute figures.

Twelve institutions with the same underlying problem — the value came from building the factory early, not from delivering the twelve

Situation

US credit unions and community banks in the roughly half-billion to three-and-a-half-billion asset range. Member-owned, community-focused, running a small number of common core-banking platforms, with small technology teams.

Each approaches a transformation as a first-of-a-kind programme for their institution, because for them it is.

Complication

Delivered as twelve bespoke programmes, the economics do not work. Each one carries full discovery, full configuration and full integration effort, at a price point these institutions can bear only once.

Delivered as twelve copies of one implementation, the fit is poor — because the genuinely institution-specific parts are the ones members actually notice.

What was built

A deployment factory: a productised platform carrying everything common — the member and account model, the core integration patterns, the servicing and lending journeys, the analytics layer — with a deliberately bounded set of things left bespoke.

The discipline is knowing which three things stay bespoke, and refusing to expand that list under client pressure.

THE NUMBERS THAT MATTER

12

institutions

~80%

of each build reused

3

categories left bespoke

2.8×

portfolio revenue, FY22–FY26

~3×

recurring revenue

1

team throughout

Why the timing matters more than the idea: every services organisation intends to productise. Almost all of them intend to do it after the current client. The factory only compounds if it is built while the delivery is still small enough to change — which in practice means during client two or three, when the case for it is weakest.

The portfolio and the productisation approach come from the delivery record; growth is expressed as reported ratios rather than absolute figures

DELIVERY RECORD

Portfolio context

The institutions served and the common estate they run, as delivered between 2020 and 2026.

- Twelve institutions delivered
- Roughly \$0.5bn–\$3.6bn asset range
- Common core-banking platforms
- Member, servicing, lending, analytics scope
- Small in-house technology teams
- Six-year continuous engagement

PRODUCTISATION

My ownership

Design, productisation and rollout of the reusable platform across the portfolio.

- Reusable platform design
- Common versus bespoke boundary
- Core integration pattern library
- Deployment method and runbooks
- Portfolio sequencing
- Requirement through production, twelve times

RATIOS

Reported

Business-unit growth stated as reported ratios. Absolute revenue figures are deliberately excluded.

- Portfolio revenue ~2.8× FY22–FY26
- Live recurring revenue ~3×
- Gross margin improving over the period
- Ratios, never absolutes
- Not independently audited
- Not attributable to one cause

OUT OF SCOPE

Not claimed

Excluded deliberately.

- Any institution's own outcomes
- Any member or account data
- Absolute revenue or pricing
- Any confidential client document
- Any single client's contract value
- Sole attribution of growth

Roughly four-fifths of every build was common — and the discipline was refusing to let the bespoke fifth grow

PRODUCTISED — BUILT ONCE

- Member, account, share, loan and card data model — identical across every institution
- Core-banking integration patterns, including the transformation and file-transfer plumbing
- Servicing case model, queues, service levels and dispositions
- Lending origination and servicing journeys
- Marketing, campaign and member-communication tooling
- Analytics layer, standard measures and the reporting set
- Deployment runbooks, environment build and test packs

BESPOKE — THREE CATEGORIES ONLY

Product and pricing configuration

Every institution's product set, rates, fees and eligibility differ, and members notice immediately. Configuration, never code.

Field of membership and eligibility

Charter areas, employer groups and community definitions are legally specific to each institution and cannot be generalised.

Third-party service estate

Card processors, digital banking providers and document systems vary by institution. Adapters are reused where the provider repeats.

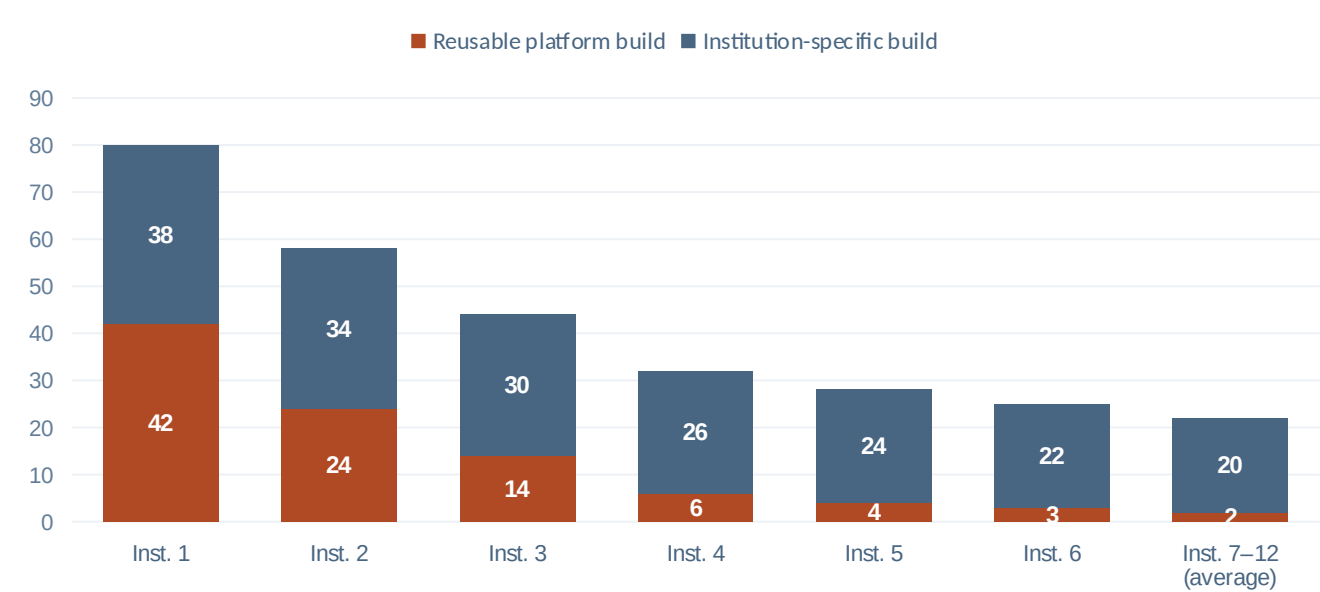
The argument that had to be won repeatedly

Every institution believes its servicing process is distinctive, and every one is partly right — the differences are real but they are almost always differences in threshold, naming and sequence rather than in structure.

The productive response is not to argue. It is to show the institution the common model, let them mark what genuinely does not fit, and then examine those items one at a time. In practice most resolve to configuration, a handful become a shared enhancement that every institution then inherits, and one or two are genuine and go in the bespoke fifth.

What cannot be allowed is the fourth category — a bespoke change made because it was faster this sprint. That single decision is what turns a factory back into twelve bespoke builds, and it is always made under delivery pressure.

The factory cost was paid across the first three institutions and returned across the next nine



Illustrative effort index per institution — the shape is the argument, not the values

The commercial consequence of a falling marginal cost

At institution one the economics only work at a price point most community institutions cannot pay twice. At institution seven the same scope is deliverable at a price they can, with better margin on both sides.

That is the actual unlock. It is not that the work got cheaper to do — it is that a market of institutions too small to fund a bespoke transformation became addressable. The portfolio revenue growth over the period follows from serving a market that was previously out of reach, not from doing the same work faster.

80

effort index,
institution one

22

effort index,
later institutions

2.8x

portfolio revenue
FY22 to FY26

~3x

live recurring
revenue

What the curve does and does not say

- Institution-specific effort falls but never approaches zero — the bespoke fifth is real work every time.
- Growth is not attributable to the factory alone; market, pricing and team all contributed.

Six practices, and only two of them are technical

A named platform owner

Governance

One person accountable for the common platform, whose authority sits above any single client delivery date. Without this the first fork happens in month three.

Enhancement, never fork

Governance

A client need that the platform does not meet becomes a platform enhancement every institution inherits, or it goes in the bespoke fifth. There is no third option.

A published common model

Method

Institutions see the standard model at the start and mark what does not fit, rather than specifying from a blank page. The list is dramatically shorter.

Deployment runbooks

Method

Environment build, configuration load, integration setup and test packs are documented artefacts, not knowledge held by whoever did the last one.

A pattern library for integration

Technical

Core-banking connections follow four established patterns rather than being designed per client. New institutions on a known core inherit the whole set.

Configuration over code, enforced

Technical

Product, pricing, eligibility and workflow are configuration. Every request to code something that could be configured is refused, including when coding is faster.

Four of the six are governance and method. The factory is not a codebase — it is a set of refusals, held consistently for six years by someone whose accountability did not sit inside any one delivery.

Four rules for productising a services portfolio

- | | | |
|----|---|---|
| 01 | Build the factory at client two or three | Every services organisation intends to productise after the current client. The window is while the delivery is small enough to change, which is exactly when the business case is weakest and the pressure to defer is strongest. |
| 02 | Bound the bespoke list and defend it | Name the categories that stay client-specific — here, product configuration, eligibility and the third-party estate — and refuse any fourth category. The bespoke fifth grows the moment a fork is allowed because it was faster that sprint. |
| 03 | Publish the common model to the client | Specifying from a blank page produces a long list of differences. Marking up a standard model produces a short one, and most items on it resolve to configuration once examined individually. |
| 04 | Sell the marginal cost, not the saving | The value of a factory is not that the work got cheaper. It is that a market of institutions too small to fund a bespoke programme becomes addressable — a different and much larger argument. |

Twelve institutions, one team, six years. The factory was not the code that got reused — it was one person with the standing to say no to a fork on the day a delivery date was at risk.